



Delaware County Council Meeting November 22nd 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WB2bTrOp5f4
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Delaware County Municipal Meeting Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by the Council President (Miss Piper).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Miss Chambers, Miss Lasseter, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Ballard, Miss Piper.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Miss Piper (President).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** General meeting proceedings commenced. **00:00:31** Approval of the October meeting minutes was moved and approved via roll call.
- **Leadership Nomination:** **00:01:02** A nomination was brought forward to appoint Ryan Ballard as President Pro Tem for the remainder of the year until reorganization in January. Approved by roll call.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:43 Tax Abatement: Living Green Farms (Resolution 2022-023)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout (Delaware County Economic Development) and Jerry gray (Plant Engineer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a phase-two investment for purchasing equipment (HVAC, growth, conveyance, harvest, watering, washing, and racking systems) utilizing aeroponics (using 98% less water) at 2450 West Fusion Road in Muncie (former shell building). The estimated equipment purchase price is \$31,696,226, creating 40 new jobs at a starting wage of \$19/hour with health insurance. The property is already declared an economic revitalization area (ERA). The proposed abatement is a 3-year phased-in tax abatement with estimated savings of \$635,380.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2022-023 approved via roll call vote.
- **00:11:10 Tax Abatement: Arc EDM Inc. (Resolution 2022-024 / ERA Designation)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, Daniel Miller, and Ashley Miller (Owners).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Located at 1800 West Mount Pleasant Boulevard, Muncie. The company plans to purchase a Titan Force 42 45-axis small hole EDM drilling machine (100% USA-made in New York) for \$269,000 to expand into the aerospace industry (GE, Rolls-Royce, Boeing). This is a 5-year abatement with estimated tax savings of \$10,530. Initial preliminary approval for the Economic Revitalization Area (ERA) was reviewed, noting a public hearing will occur before final December adoption.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Preliminary ERA approval (Resolution 2022-024) approved via roll call vote.
- **00:13:36 Ordinance 2022-028: County Employee Salaries & Hiring Procedures**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented as a consolidated ordinance to combine and simplify county employee definitions, salaries, and hiring procedures (excluding merit officers), reducing individual line items and addressing part-time hourly pay increases.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board members discussed past adjustments, removal of college degree requirements (retained as preferences only if at all), and part-time pay equity.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for first reading; set for public hearing prior to the December meeting.
- **00:27:46 Financial Transfers & Addendums**
 - **Commissioners (County General):** Transfer within FICA, part-time, and cleaning supplies. Approved by voice/roll call.
 - **Prosecutor Office:** Transfer between Deputy Prosecutor salary lines. Approved.

- **Circuit Court:** Transfer from probation officer salary to Comcast/air cards (\$4,200). Discussion regarding running hard lines for judges' offices vs. streaming options. *Amendment:* Motion to approve only the juvenile air cards (\$100 / line 325) passed via roll call (00:39:18). Cable hard-line funding was split/voted down for further December clarification.
- **Jail Department:** Transfer from testing to staff uniform allowances (\$2,700). Approved.
- **Title IV-D Court:** Transfer from assistant court reporter to health insurance. Approved.
- **Public Defender's Office:** Transfer from former employee salary to postage (\$675). Approved.
- **Auditor's Office:** Transfer from imaging annual support to equipment (\$1,000) for a new computer. Approved.
- **Adult User Fee:** Transfer between PERF and health insurance. Approved.
- **CASA Fund:** Transfer between PERF and health insurance. Approved.
- **High-Tech Crime Unit:** Transfer adjusting travel and repairs into supplies (\$859.42) for storage media. Approved.
- **Public Defender Supplemental:** Transfer adjusting life/disability insurance and file maintenance. Approved.
- **Communications Department (Addendum):** Line item corrections and adjustments for supplies, maintenance, schooling, miscellaneous equipment, and chairs. Approved (00:54:38).
- **EMS Department:** Adjustments reflecting staffing shortages, moving unused EMT/medic pay lines into overtime (\$21,000). Approved (00:56:35).
- **Jail Department Addendum:** Correctional officer salary realignments for new hires. Approved (00:57:46).
- **Prosecutor / Surveyor / Highway / GIS / 9-1-1 Addendums:** Various staff vacancy reallocations, stipends, and line balancing.
 - *Special Note on 9-1-1 Stipends (01:13:00):* Re-designated director and deputy director stipends into specific line items (124 and 125) to maintain transparency outside base salaries. Amended and approved via roll call (01:15:30).
- **01:16:08 Special Appropriations & Additional Appropriations**
 - **Commissioners (County General - Institutional Care):** Appropriation of \$137,499.96. Approved via roll call (01:16:37).
 - **Prosecutor Office:** Appropriation of \$13,600 for legal services/transcripts (\$10,000), computer equipment (\$2,500), and office furniture (\$1,100). Approved via roll call (01:18:29).
 - **Other Elected Official Training Fund:** Clerk schooling (\$3,000). Approved (01:19:21).
 - **Recovery Court Grant:** Life/disability insurance (\$9). Approved (01:20:39).

- **Public Defender Supplemental:** FICA and PERF (\$1,255). Approved (01:21:20).
- **Commissioners (Health Insurance - Account 4701):** Appropriation of \$300,000 to cover end-of-year health insurance claim shortfalls. Detailed discussion regarding historical self-insurance expenses and year-end utilization. Approved via roll call (01:31:43).
- **Campus Building (Security Badges):** Appropriation of \$2,272.75 for security badge building cubes. Approved (01:34:03).
- **01:35:05 Board Appointments: Fair Board**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Melanie presented fair board appointments, requesting the reappointment of Bart Kiesling (noted as vital for grandstand and heavy equipment fair operations). Discussion ensued regarding tabling appointments for incoming council members versus making immediate appointments due to the fair board's January convention.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to reappoint Bart Kiesling carried via roll call (01:50:14), leaving other structural positions for the January council.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:01:27 Christopher Bilbrey:** Addressed the council regarding the prior month's removal of public comment from the agenda, emphasizing the duty of elected officials and meeting decorum.
- **02:05:27 Jeff Hager:** Spoke regarding meeting decorum, criticizing the handling of public disagreement and attorney conduct during previous sessions.
- **02:14:47 Mike Jones:** Spoke in tribute to departing council members (Ron Quakenbush, Mary Chambers, Ryan Ballard), praising their years of municipal service and institutional knowledge.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:**
 - **01:51:43** The 2023 County Council meeting schedules and finance deadlines were reviewed and approved.
 - **02:21:25** The next regular meeting is scheduled for Tuesday, December 13th.
- **Adjournment:** **02:21:35** Official motion to adjourn approved by voice/roll call.